

Dim Sum Around the World

Naturally, China is the best place to eat dim sum, but cities outside Asia with large Chinese communities come a close second. From London to Sydney and San Francisco, top-class dim sum is increasingly available in gastronomic hubs around the world.

HONG KONG

Tim Ho Wan Shop inexpensive

8 Tai Yuen Mansion, 2–20 Kwong Wa Street, Mong Kok, Kowloon; +86 852 2332 2896

The world's least expensive Michelin-starred restaurant, with lines stretching around the block – take a number and go shopping for an hour. Their flaky barbecued pork buns, richly flavored turnip cake, and perfect *har gau* are not to be missed.

Din Tai Fung moderate

3/F Silvercord Centre, 30 Canton Road, Tsim Sha Tsui, Kowloon; +86 852 2730 6928

Courteous service, bright, bustling, and everything above average. The specialties are various *xiaolong bao* (dumplings normally stuffed with pork, though one version here comes filled with taro paste), but save room for the crunchy jellyfish and radish salad.

Luk Yu Tea House expensive

24 Stanley Street, Central; +86 852 2523 1970

Perhaps a little overpriced, but it's the ambience that makes this not to be missed: pure 1930s teahouse, with ceiling fans, dark wooden booths, and ancient staff wearing crisply starched linen.

GUANGZHOU, CHINA

Sprawling, overcrowded Guangzhou, capital of Guangdong province, shares the same energy, language, and cuisine as Hong Kong. But at over 2,000 years old, it has rather more history.

Liwan Mingshijia inexpensive

99 Dishifu Lu; +86 20 8139 1405

This open-fronted cafeteria on Guangzhou's famous food street is always packed to bursting – sharing tables is inevitable and even Cantonese-speakers have trouble ordering above the din. It is best for exquisitely thin-skinned *cheung fun*, juicy won ton, and *shuang pi nai* (custardlike “double-skinned milk”).

Chao Hao moderate

6/F World Trade Centre, 371 Huanshi Dong Lu; +86 20 8769 0888

Smart and sophisticated decor makes Chao Hao a favorite place for indulging in crispy-skinned pork, stewed chickens' feet, and Hong Kong-style mango pudding, though the specialty dish here is *fun gwor* – dumplings from northeastern Guangdong province.

Tao Tao Ju moderate

20 Dishifu Lu; +86 20 8139 9632

The roast goose – a Cantonese specialty – and the crumbly *char siu* rolls alone justify the reputation of this century-old restaurant, which claims to have more than 200 dim sum dishes on the menu. The greatest variety is available after 2:00 PM.

SINGAPORE

This tiny city-state sitting at the tip of the Malay Peninsula was, like Hong Kong, founded by the British. With its mix of colonial, Chinese, Malay, and Indian heritage, Singapore is one of Southeast Asia's trading hubs.

Yan Ting moderate

The St Regis Hotel, 29 Tangling Road; +65 6506 6866

Probably the finest dim sum in Singapore, served in suave surroundings by attentive staff. The *char siu* roast pork is meltingly soft, the *har gau* dumplings firm and smooth, and their soup stocks awash with complex but subtle flavors.

SYDNEY, AUSTRALIA

Chinese migrants came to Australia during the country's 19th-century gold rushes and stayed to run market gardens and stores. There are good-sized Chinatowns in all state capitals, but Sydney's is probably the liveliest.

East Ocean Seafood inexpensive

421–9 Sussex Street, Haymarket; www.eastocean.com.au

Come prepared to stand in line at this authentically busy, hot, and noisy dim sum legend, which delivers consistently fine scallop dumplings, steamed black-bean spare ribs, and fried vegetable rolls. Hong Kong expats get positively misty-eyed over their *do fu fa* (tofu custard).

